

The Dead of Night

A creation of: Derek Chapman



GREETINGS FELLOW DUNGEON MASTERS.

For your information, the dungeon which is presented in this module was generated by the DunGen dungeon generator, created by Steve Alvarez. Although the dungeon's rooms monsters and traps were generated by the DunGen dungeon generator, you should note that the story line and all NPC's are a creation of yours truly, Derek Chapman. If you like the dungeon in this module you can download the generation utility at <http://rpghost.com/DunGen/> or you can contact DunGen's creator via Email at salvarez@yahoo.com. This is my first attempt at designing a module for online submission so please send me your questions and comments. You can reach me by email at Thonginvader00@hotmail.com. This module is for personal use only and not to be sold or distributed for money. This module is set in the forgotten realms campaign setting. With all the formalities out of the way we can finally get to the adventure. Here it is, I hope you enjoy it.

(My Players were between levels 6-9 when they played this module, but ultimately its up to you the DM to decide)

PART 1 (THE INTRODUCTION)

This adventure begins at a tavern in a small town. Which town is up to the DM, this module requires that there be an undiscovered catacomb underneath the town, so don't use a town that has mines or any other underground fixture that the local people know of.

(Section 1)

The PC's are resting in the small inn after having come off some recent adventure. They are enjoying themselves but little do they know that the bartender (a short, bald, pudgy sort) has been poisoning their drinks all night with mild sedatives. Read the following to the players.

Life is good, At least for now. Long has it been since you can remember a time when the ale has flown so freely, every wench has possessed a full set of teeth, and the food and entertainment have been so good. You sit and indulge draught after draught from your shiny silver tankards, while listening to a bard from a faraway land spin beautiful tales of fair maidens and chivalrous knights. You can't help but dwell on your past adventures. All the time you wonder what the fates will bring you next. Will Tymora smile upon you, or will the wicked Beshaba extend her foot to trip you? Who knows? One thing is for sure, tonight, nothing could go wrong.

After a while the festivities begin to die down. People are starting to leave in a steady pattern, and the bard is packing away his lute. Night has overtaken the land and the bar patrons are going home to their wives and children.

The bard, dressed in fine and exotic silks, turns his attention to your group. His deep azure eyes are in some ways hypnotic. He approaches you and says in a very low whisper, "If you wish to live, follow me". He then he walks to the corner furthest from the bar and sits down in the booth located there

If the PC's do not follow the bard he will order a drink, take a few draughts and leave. Upon that time the PC's must make a Save vs. Poison at -5 or pass out cold from the sedatives. If all the players pass out the bartender will simply slit their throats one by one. If any of the PC's manage to make their saves continue at section 2.

If the PC's decide to follow the bard read the following to them.

As you approach the bard he looks at you with a thoughtful stare and says in the same whisper that you've come to know him by, "Please sit my friends, and speak in whispers. My name is Karragen and I have information that could quite possibly save your lives. For a price of course."

The amount of information divulged to the players depends upon the amount that they are willing to pay. Read the appropriate text aloud to the PC's.

1-14 gold pieces: Karragen says "Surely your lives are worth more to you than a few measly coins. I'm afraid this is not enough money to give you information as valuable as this."

15-29 gold pieces: Karragen says "This is all that your lives are worth to you, (sigh) no matter, listen well. The barkeep has been poisoning your drinks with a sleeping drug. I saw him mixing the drug with your ales. That is all I know."

30+ gold pieces: Karragen says "Listen to me, and listen good my friends. The barkeep has been poisoning your drinks for some time now. I saw him mixing in some sort of sedative sleeping drug. I also heard him speaking of a man coming here tonight to kill you all, I cannot help you with the assassin, but I do have an antidote for the drug you have been given". He then proceeds to pull a flask of blue Liquid from his pack and says "you must each take one draught from this flask to neutralize the poison you have been given."

Karragen doesn't know the bartender's motives and will gladly tell the PC's that he doesn't. When the conversation ends read the following to the players.

Karragen yawns and says, "Well I really must be going now. I am quite tired and I've still got business to attend elsewhere. Fare well compatriots, and godspeed." He then stands and walks to the exit, after picking up his instrument.

Name	XP	THAC0	Level	# of attacks	Damage	Hit Points	Alignment
Karragen	-	18	7	1	1d4 by dagger	36	Neutral

If attacked or harassed Karragen will flee.

If the PCs find out that they have been poisoned and are actively trying to stay awake the poison save will be attempted without the -5 penalty. Either way if the PCs make their saving throw checks they will manage to fight off sleep for another 4 hours, however all attack rolls made in that time will be made at a -3 due to drowsiness. The blue liquid given to them by Karragen will neutralize the poison.

1a) If the PCs were to loud when they were conversing with the bard, the chances are the bartender overheard them and disappeared (ran) along with both of the serving wenches. A search of the premises will reveal the bartender along with the wenches, cut and shredded into a bloody pile of gore, and stuffed inside the pantry along side the herbs and spices.

1b) however if the PCs were quiet in their conversation with the bard read the following passage to them.

Standing behind the bar the pudgy, bald little form of the bartender flashes you a smile. You look around only to find that your party, the wenches and the bartender are now the only occupants of the tavern. The bartender say's "Well I'm sorry to say but I'm afraid it's almost closing time, have one last round on the house, for being my best customer's tonight." He begins to fill your tankards.

If the PCs refuse, the bartender will insist. If they still refuse, try to question the bartender, or take any aggressive actions toward him, read the following passage to the players.

The bartender stands resolute as he looks you into the eyes and says "Damn you adventurers! Must you do everything the hard way." The pudgy man and both wenches begin to transform right in front of your eyes, morphing into strange looking humanoids with solid white eyes and hairless gray skin. The former bartender shouts to the other two creatures in a funny high-pitched voice, "Come on you two we have to hold them here until Braxius arrives." You brace yourselves for the inevitable battle that is about to ensue.

Monster	Xp	Treasure	AC	Att#	Move	Damage	THAC0	Hit Dice	Hit Points
Doppelganger	420		5	1	9	1d12	17	4	30
Doppelganger	420		5	1	9	1d12	17	4	23
Doppelganger	420		5	1	9	1d12	17	4	25

After the fight if the PCs search the Tavern they will find the bartender and the wenches in the same shape as described before, shredded and dismembered in the pantry.

(Section 2)

After the fight is over, the bodies are found, or if the PCs didn't follow the bard and still made their saves. Read the following to the players.

"You barely have time to gather your wits before the Tavern door is splintered into a thousand pieces. Through the door steps a giant of a man who can only be described as scary. The man is a towering 7' tall with thick and healthy folds of jet-black hair cascading down his broad shoulders. His neck and arms are the thickness of tree trunks, his eyes are a deep and disturbing purple. You know his gleaming plate mail must conceal thick, rippling muscles. The symbol of a black hand trapped within a red shield is emblazoned upon his wide forehead. He carries a two-handed sword with a jewel encrusted ebony hilt.

Following directly behind him are five human like beings with tough leathery looking skin that appears to be decaying and falling away. A hateful light burn's in their ominous eyes, and they stink of death. They are each brandishing long swords in their rotting hands.

The dark-haired man looks to each of you and in a deep menacing voice says, "Finally we meet. I've heard a lot about your little group. I had a brother who was a diviner, who once told me that the only thing that could stop me from ruling all of Toril was an adventuring party, he described exactly like yourselves. That was right before I cleaved his skull with my sword. I have spent the last 3 months of my life tracking you and plotting. By ending your pathetic existence I will finally have a firm grasp on Toril, and I, Braxius, lord of the living dead will finally be granted the power I am due." He then beckons his undead servants and says in a dark and low tone, "Attack." He then turns and disappears into the night from whence he came.

If the PCs didn't follow the bard and still made their save vs Poison then the doppelgangers will change to their original form and join the fray. Stats for the doppelgangers can be found in section 1a.

Monster	XP	Treasure	AC	Att#	Move	Damage	Thaco	Hit Dice	Hit Points
Zombie, ju ju	975		6	1	9	1d10+2	15	3+12	24
Zombie, ju ju	975		6	1	9	1d10+2	15	3+12	29
Zombie, ju ju	975		6	1	9	1d10+2	15	3+12	29
Zombie, ju ju	975		6	1	9	1d10+2	15	3+12	19
Zombie, ju ju	975		6	1	9	1d10+2	15	3+12	32

PART 2 (THE QUEST)

(Section 1)

When the PCs leave the tavern they will discover that the whole town is empty and dead quiet. But what they do not know is that Braxius has had the town slaughtered by doppelganger assassins in the silence of the night. And he had it all done while the PCs were relaxing in the tavern. He then raised them as undead minions. Since the town is small it is up to the DM just how much loot there is to be found, (just don't give away too much too soon in the module.) Read the following to the PCs

You set foot out of the once jovial tavern to a strange atmosphere of dead silence. No one is about and the normally busy little community is completely motionless. After a brief look around, you see that in many places the ground is soaked with blood, but strangely enough, aside from the occasional severed limb, there are no bodies to be found. Suddenly, to your surprise, you hear a shaky and nervous voice coming from the shadows, "Please, listen to me. You may be all of Toril's only hope. The man who you seek is known as Braxius. I knew his brother, I studied magic with him, before Braxius killed him". A pale and weak man steps out from the shadows wearing the purple robes of the war wizards. He appears to be frail and weak, but behind his wise eyes hides power unfortold "I am Slagel, war wizard of Cormyr. I was sent here by Vangerdahast himself to destroy Braxius. He is a warrior who has gone quite mad, He used to be so kind and benevolent. But I fear that all of that has changed now. It has come to the attention of the Court of the Purple Dragon that Braxius has discovered a relic with unimaginable power. The artifact of which I speak is called the Crystal of The Undead. With this artifact Braxius has gained the ability to raise and command legions of these unholy monstrosities. But also through this artifact Braxius has gone insane, as it is said that the artifact would do to any who possess it. He has become power mad. He now seeks to rule all of Toril under the oppression of his undead legions. And with the Crystal of the Undead, it is very possible for him to do just that. Our prophecies speak of a band of adventurers that will be the only hope of for Faerun and the rest of Toril, and you my friends are those adventurers. It was folly for me to challenge Braxius. But we had to do something. We could not just sit idol and let this mad man reek havok on the land. But alas, I have failed. It is luck that I have run into you my friends. I beseech you, for all of Toril will you stop this mad man?" Before you have a chance to answer the wizard he falls to the ground like a limp oil cloth and you notice for the first time the horribly fatal wounds on his back. With weak shaking hands he hands you a map marked (Entrance to the forgotten ruins of Kalthrax). And with his last living breath he says" you must go to these ruins were Braxius hides and seek the Crystal of Life to destroy his evil, and save Toril. Please adventurers, do not fail me." With that he ceases to breathe and his eyes roll into his head. Now you have a choice adventurers, will you seek this Crystal of Life. And put an end to Braxius's evil plans? Or will you wait and see if the old wizards prophecy comes to pass. Indeed it would seem that the whole world depends upon your decision.

The PCs will weigh out their options. Inevitably they will look at the map. It shows that the entrance to the forgotten ruins lie underneath this very town. The entrance is in the third stall of the local stables. It is hidden by a magical illusion. To find the entrance the map says that the PCs must stand in the third stall of the stables and speak the words Vlac Smun Gan Furm, at which time the entrance will show itself. They will have no trouble finding the stables. When the PCs finally reach the stables and say the magic words, an iron door with intricately crafted features. It is not locked but it is however very heavy. It will take a combined strength score of 25 to lift the door open. It is dark in the there, to continue further, the PCs will need a light source. Now the real fun begins!

The forgotten ruins of Kalthrax